

Northbridge Retail Solutions Pvt. Ltd.

Employee Handbook — HR Policy Manual

This handbook describes the leave, attendance, conduct, reimbursement, and grievance policies applicable to all full-time employees of Northbridge Retail Solutions Pvt. Ltd. It is effective from April 1, 2026 and supersedes all previous versions of this document.

Employees are expected to read this document carefully and reach out to the HR department for any clarification regarding the policies described here.

1. Working Hours and Attendance

Standard working hours are from 9:30 AM to 6:30 PM, Monday through Friday, with a one-hour lunch break between 1:00 PM and 2:00 PM. Employees are expected to log in and out using the biometric attendance system at the main entrance of each office location.

Attendance is calculated on a monthly basis. An employee's monthly attendance percentage is computed as (number of days present divided by number of working days in the month) multiplied by 100. Employees must maintain a minimum monthly attendance of 90% to remain eligible for the monthly performance bonus described in Section 5.

Any employee arriving more than 15 minutes after the standard start time on more than three occasions in a calendar month will receive a formal attendance advisory from their reporting manager.

2. Leave Policy

Northbridge Retail Solutions provides the following categories of leave to all full-time employees, prorated based on the employee's date of joining during their first year of employment:

- Casual Leave: 12 days per calendar year
- Sick Leave: 10 days per calendar year
- Earned/Privilege Leave: 15 days per calendar year, accrued monthly
- Maternity Leave: 26 weeks, as per the Maternity Benefit Act
- Paternity Leave: 10 working days

All leave requests must be submitted through the HR portal at least 3 working days in advance, except in the case of sick leave, which may be applied for on the day of absence with manager approval.

2.1 Leave Carry-Forward and Encashment

Up to 10 days of unused Earned Leave may be carried forward to the following calendar year.

Any Earned Leave balance beyond 10 days as of December 31st will be automatically encashed at the employee's current basic salary rate and credited with the January payroll.

Casual Leave and Sick Leave cannot be carried forward or encashed and will lapse at the end of the calendar year.

2.2 Unpaid Leave

Employees who have exhausted all applicable leave categories may apply for unpaid leave, subject to approval by their reporting manager and the HR department. Unpaid leave beyond 30 consecutive days requires approval from the Head of HR.

3. Code of Conduct

All employees are expected to maintain the highest standards of professional integrity, including honesty in reporting, respect for colleagues, and compliance with applicable laws and company policies. Harassment, discrimination, or retaliation of any kind will not be tolerated and may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination.

Employees must not disclose confidential company information, including financial data, customer records, or proprietary business strategies, to any external party without prior written authorization.

4. Travel and Expense Reimbursement

Employees traveling for official business purposes may claim reimbursement for travel, accommodation, and meal expenses, subject to the limits defined in the Travel Policy Annexure. All claims must be submitted through the Expense Management System within 15 days of travel, accompanied by valid receipts.

Reimbursement claims exceeding INR 10,000 require prior approval from the employee's department head before the expense is incurred.

5. Grievance Redressal

Employees who wish to raise a workplace grievance may do so through the confidential HR helpdesk or by emailing grievance@northbridgeretail.example. All grievances will be acknowledged within 2 working days and resolved within 15 working days, in accordance with the company's Grievance Redressal Policy.

Employees may escalate unresolved grievances to the Internal Complaints Committee for further review.